

■ Feedforward

■ What is it?

Providing suggestions to do better moving forward.

Instead of telling people what they *did wrong*, feedforward guides them on what they *can do next*.

For example, before submitting a form, you might see a checklist: **“Make sure your email is valid and all fields are filled.”**

■■ History

The concept of feedforward was popularized in management and communication studies by **Marshall Goldsmith (2002)**.

It was designed as a **future-focused alternative to feedback**, helping people improve through guidance instead of criticism.

In UX, feedforward became important for **error prevention**, reducing frustration, and making digital flows smoother.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- People perform better when they know **what to expect**.
- Feedback reacts to the past, while feedforward **prevents mistakes in advance**.
- This lowers cognitive load and boosts confidence because users feel supported, not judged.

When done well, feedforward creates more **intuitive and successful experiences**.

■■ Why It Matters

Feedforward can:

- Reduce user errors
- Prevent backtracking

- Increase task completion rates
- Improve confidence and trust
- Reduce support queries
- Make flows feel smooth and intuitive

■ How to Apply It

- **Provide hints and tips** → small prompts that guide the next step.
- **Use pre-action checklists** → validate before errors occur.
- **Show progress indicators** → help users know what's ahead.
- **Use previews** → let users see results before committing.
- **Apply progressive disclosure** → reveal only what's needed at the right time.

■ Theory in Action

- **LinkedIn** suggests the next step after uploading a profile—like adding skills or connecting with others.
- **Forms and apps** often highlight missing fields *before* you press “Submit,” saving time and frustration.

■ Final Thought

Feedback tells people what already happened. **Feedforward helps them succeed in the future.**

By guiding users proactively, you not only prevent mistakes but also make them feel **smart, supported, and in control.**